

Opinion of the Court

This analysis is deeply flawed. The *Bivens* inquiry does not invite federal courts to independently assess the costs and benefits of implying a cause of action. A court faces only one question: whether there is *any* rational reason (even one) to think that *Congress* is better suited to “weigh the costs and benefits of allowing a damages action to proceed.” *Ziglar*, 582 U. S., at 136. Thus, a court should not inquire, as the Court of Appeals did here, whether *Bivens* relief is appropriate in light of the balance of circumstances in the “particular case.” *Stanley*, 483 U. S., at 683. A court inevitably will “impai[r]” governmental interests, and thereby frustrate Congress’ policymaking role, if it applies the “‘special factors’ analysis” at such a narrow “leve[l] of generality.” *Id.*, at 681. Rather, under the proper approach, a court must ask “[m]ore broadly” if there is any reason to think that “judicial intrusion” into a given field might be “harmful” or “inappropriate.” *Ibid.* If so, or even if there is the “*potential*” for such consequences, a court cannot afford a plaintiff a *Bivens* remedy. *Ziglar*, 582 U. S., at 140, 148 (emphasis added). As in *Hernández*, then, we ask here whether a court is competent to authorize a damages action not just against Agent Egbert but against Border Patrol agents generally. The answer, plainly, is no. See *Hernández*, 589 U. S., at — (refusing to extend *Bivens* into the “field” of “border security”).

The Court of Appeals’ analysis betrays the pitfalls of applying the special-factors analysis at too granular a level. The court rested on three irrelevant distinctions from *Hernández*. First, Agent Egbert was several feet from (rather than straddling) the border, but cross-border security is obviously implicated in either event. Second, Boule’s guest arrived in Seattle from New York rather than abroad, but an alien’s port of entry does not make him less likely to be a national-security threat. And third, Agent Egbert investigated immigration violations on our side of the border, not Canada’s, but immigration investigations in *this* country are